

Tamrack

New Employee Orientation Program Evaluation



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OPWL 530 Evaluation

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Background

Tamrack, Inc. is a cleaning supply company serving hospitals and nursing homes with more than 200 employees in five states. In 2020, the company's Learning and Performance Solutions (LPS) department revised its New Employee Onboarding (NEO) program for virtual delivery. Since then, the program has undergone several revisions, but no formal program evaluation has been conducted.

At the request of the Director of Learning and Performance Solutions (Gill Gibson), the evaluation team conducted a formative, goal-based evaluation of the NEO program. The evaluation scope was limited to the structured first week onboarding experience. Pre-boarding activities and the informal one-month integration period were excluded.

The evaluation was designed to assess two dimensions identified in collaboration with the client and aligned to the program logic model: (1) "Feeling Welcomed" - whether new hires feel welcomed and integrated into Tamrack's culture and values, and (2) "Role Readiness" - whether new hires are prepared to begin learning their roles with their managers and teams.

Evaluation Methodology

The evaluation team used both qualitative and quantitative methods of evaluation, collecting data from two stakeholder groups using four instruments:

- Participant survey (n=27): self-administered, anonymous, web-based
- Manager survey (n=14): self-administered, anonymous, web-based
- Participant interviews (n=4): voluntary, semi-structured, via video conference
- Manager interviews (n=3): voluntary, semi-structured, via video conference

Quantitative survey items used a 5-point Likert rating scale: (1) Strongly Disagree, (2) Somewhat Disagree, (3) Neither Agree nor Disagree, (4) Somewhat Agree, (5) Strongly Agree. Percentage summaries are reported as % Agree (score of 4-5), % Neutral (score of 3), and % Disagree (score of 1-2).

Open-ended survey responses and interview transcripts were coded by theme and sentiment using a codebook developed by the evaluation team.

For each dimension, the evaluation team applied rubrics to assign one of four ratings to the data source: Exceeds Expectations, Met Expectations, Improvement Needed, or Serious Problems. Source-level ratings were then triangulated at the dimensional level using the triangulation rubrics found in Appendix C.

Evaluation Results

Both dimensions were rated Met Expectations based on triangulated findings.

“Feeling Welcomed” Evaluation Results

The “Feeling Welcomed” dimension showed strong quantitative results in all data sources. Participant survey responses were especially high, with a composite mean of 4.81 out of 5 and no respondent selecting Strongly or Somewhat Disagree on any welcome-related items. First-week engagement was high as well: 100% of new hires reported meeting with their manager, 92.6% met with their team, and 77.8% met with an assigned mentor. The participant survey rated Exceeds Expectations.

Interviews and open-ended survey responses told a different story. Participants described the orientation as impersonal and reported limited connection outside their immediate team. The survey scores were high, but the welcome experience was uneven. The interviews both rated Met Expectations.

Because the triangulation rubric requires both sources to be rated Exceeds Expectations, the overall rating for this dimension was determined to be Met Expectations.

“Role Readiness” Evaluation Results

The “Role Readiness” dimension also showed strong quantitative performance, with manager survey ratings at 4.68 out of 5, and no Strongly Disagree or Somewhat Disagree options selected on any items. Therefore, the manager survey was rated as Exceeds Expectations for the “Role Readiness” dimension.

However, NEO participants rated their own role readiness slightly lower than managers, with a composite participant survey mean of 4.55 out of 5. Most items scored above 4.4, with access to tools and systems highest at 4.96. Self-paced learning was the weakest item (mean 3.63) and the only item in either dimension where respondents selected Strongly Disagree or Somewhat Disagree. Among the participant survey items, self-paced learning showed the highest association with the overall readiness ($r=0.251$, $n=27$), though with a sample size this small, the correlation is still weak. The participant survey rated Met Expectations for the “Role Readiness” dimension.

Both manager and participant interviews rated this dimension Met Expectations, citing gaps in department-specific systems, benefits knowledge, on-the-job training, content relevance, and post-orientation structure.

Table 1 summarizes each data source's rating, the triangulated dimension rating, and the importance weighting of each dimension.

Table 1. Triangulated Dimensional Scoring

Dimension	Source Ratings	Triangulated Rating	Importance Weighting
Feeling Welcomed	• Participant survey: Exceeds • Participant Interview: Met	Met Expectations	Critical
Role Readiness	• Manager survey: Exceeds • Participant survey: Met • Manager interview: Met • Participant interview: Met	Met Expectations	Critical

Conclusions

The NEO program is performing well against its two primary outcomes. New hires report feeling welcome and connected to Tamrack's culture, and managers confirm that new hires demonstrate baseline readiness to begin learning their roles.

The program's clearest strength is cultural and relational onboarding. Manager engagement in the first week is universal, team engagement is near universal, and the welcome composite score is 4.81 out of 5 with no respondent selecting Strongly or Somewhat Disagree. The Day 1 synchronous orientation, values messaging, and team-level introductions are consistently cited as effective.

The clearest area for improvement is the self-paced learning experience. It scored the lowest of any item, was the only one where respondents selected Strongly or Somewhat Disagree, and came up more than anything else in interviews with both participants and managers. Participants described content as too dense for the first week and insufficiently connected to their actual job tasks.

The evaluation team's recommendations, presented in full in Section 6.2, address three areas in priority order:

1. Restructure the self-paced learning experience. Spread content over two to four weeks instead of compressing it into week one. Tailor modules to different roles, and replace some of the passive reading with short exercises based on realistic job tasks.
2. Make mentor meetings more consistent. Not every new hire is getting the same experience, so set a few required check-ins during the first two weeks with simple guidance on what to cover.

3. Help new hires connect outside their own team. The team-level welcome is strong, but new hires described limited connection to the rest of the organization. Adding cross-team introductions or a peer cohort would close that gap.

The evaluation scope was limited to the structured first-week experience, but the data pointed to root causes that cannot be fully resolved within the first week alone. These recommendations address problems identified within the evaluated scope but propose changes that extend into the wider onboarding timeline.

Limitations

The evaluation has several limitations. The sample size is small: 27 participants and 14 managers on the surveys, and interview samples of 4 and 3, respectively. The evaluation only covers the 2025 cohort. And participants who completed onboarding in January are drawing on much older memories than those who finished in December.

All semi-structured interviews were conducted by the client (LPS Director), not by the evaluation team. Respondents knew they were speaking with the person who runs the program, which may have led them to soften their feedback. The interview and survey findings were generally in line with each other, which partially offsets this risk, but both data sources may reflect a degree of social desirability bias.

The HR Director was unavailable throughout the evaluation period. The LPS Director was the sole upstream stakeholder and provided program context and organizational priorities, which should be considered when interpreting findings related to program design intent.

The evaluation team is confident in the overall dimensional findings. However, the sample size is too small to support reliable comparisons of different departments or quarters. Any patterns observed may suggest areas worth watching, but should not be treated as definitive findings.